SANDOR HERNANDEZ

MIAMI MARKET BRIEF · TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026

Three things moving Florida deals today.

Appraisals are getting longer, FHA financing is opening up for thin-credit buyers, and new-construction buyers want more flexible space. Here's what each means for your next deal.

Have a deal in mind? Let's run the numbers.

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01 · APPRAISALS

What the appraisal overhaul means for your deals

45–50 pages

New appraisal reports will include considerably more property detail, with some running 45 to 50 pages or longer. Lenders may qualify for temporary exceptions during the transition.

PUT IT TO WORK

- Ask your lender whether their appraisal provider is ready for the new format.
- Give the appraiser accurate, complete property information up front.
- Build realistic financing deadlines into contracts to absorb possible delays.

02 · FINANCING

HUD talks more homes, more buyers in Florida

January

HUD Secretary Scott Turner brought his homeownership message to Florida, outlining plans to encourage more homebuilding and help younger Americans qualify for mortgages.

PUT IT TO WORK

- More construction could eventually mean more choices for Florida buyers on a budget.
- New FHA credit-scoring options arriving in January could help some renters with limited credit histories qualify.
- Renters who were told 'not yet' may be worth a second conversation in the new year.

03 · BUYER TRENDS

One home office? Buyers are asking for a second

2 offices

Home offices are high on the wish list for new-construction buyers, with hobby rooms and playrooms close behind. Flexible space deserves a closer look.

PUT IT TO WORK

- Ask buyers what they need extra rooms to do: work, hobbies or family.
- Show how bonus rooms and flex spaces can serve more than one use.
- Describe functional spaces accurately in listings rather than assuming one setup fits all.

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